

need to go through all the files to find that particular XLS or DOC files. Go to Panel on the Menu bar and select Filter. Next, enter the extension you are looking for and click on Accept. Now, when you browse through files and folders, only the extension that has been put into the filter will be displayed and not all the files.

Adding bookmarks

If you plan to use Xfe as the default file browser then you can also add bookmarks within it. So if you want to access a file deep within a folder, there will be a bookmark ready for it. To add a bookmark, first go to the folder you want to bookmark. Then go to bookmarks on the menu bar and select Add Bookmark. [Ctrl]+[B] is a shortcut to bookmark the folders visited.

Emptying trash

Not all Linux distros have trash cans displayed on the desktop where you can empty trash. Xfe has its own Trash, so when you delete a file while using Xfe that particular file goes to the trash can. To access this trash can, either press [Ctrl]+[F8] or you could go to Trash on the menu bar and then Select Go to Trash. To empty the trash, you can go to trash and then select Empty Trash Can or you can directly do it by pressing [Ctrl]+[Del].

Kexi

Kexi is a Relations Database Management software which is the Linux equivalent to Microsoft Access. Kexi allows you to create forms, queries and tables and input data into them and allows you to store this information as a relational database. Creating forms with a custom interface will now be possible using this software.

Creating a table

To start a new project, you either go to File and then select New from the menu bar or you can just use the shortcut [Ctrl]+[N].

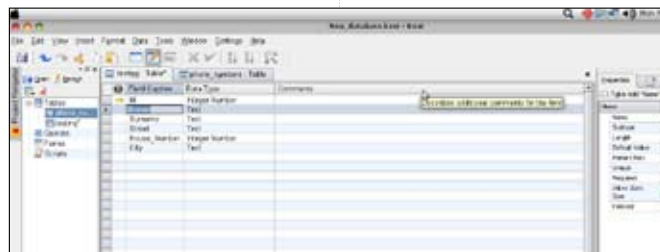
The Kexi interface has different tool bars. On the left of the screen, you have the Project Navigator's Panel where you can quickly browse between tables, queries, scripts and forms. With the Project Navigator's Pane, you can also create new tables, queries and forms. To do so, you need to right-click on Tables and then select Create Object: Table. The same procedure can be followed for Queries, Forms and Scripts. Alternatively, you can create a new table by going to Insert on the menu bar and then click on Table, Query, Form or Script.

Once you have created a new table, you will see a page full of rows and columns. On the right, there is a properties window which will display the properties of each cell selected. This is called the Property Editor pane.

Table designing

To start off, the table designer window has some fixed columns. The first column is the primary key column. Next to that is the field caption where your data pertaining to the relative field will be entered. After that is the data type where you can choose the appropriate data type for your field. These data types can be selected from a drop down combo box menu. For example, if you add 'Name' to the field caption then the corresponding data type would be Text. The last column here is the comments column where any extra information related to the field can be added so that people can understand that field better.

If you want to create a field with images then the data type should be set to Object.



The Table Designing window in Kexi



Switch to Data view to input data

When typing in the field caption columns, field names should not start with numbers, they can start with letters or an underscore sign '_'. The underscore sign should also be used in the field name instead of using spaces or dashes. When you have a field name such as house_number, then the corresponding data type should be "Integer Number". You can quickly access the drop down menu by hitting [F4] or even by using [Alt]+Down Arrow. If you have a field corresponding to phone_number, the data type should be set as Text instead of Integer Number as special characters will be used for area codes.

Entering data

Once you have your basic table field setup, you can start filling in the data. To get to the data entry mode, you need to click on the switch to data view button on the tool bar menu. You can also go to View and then select Data view from the menu bar. A quick way to switch to the Data view window is by pressing the [F6] key. If you want to go back to the Design view then you just need to press the [F7] key.

If you have set the data type of the field to Object then in the Data view window you will get a drop down from where you can add the image by

selecting Insert From File. A small thumbnail of the image will be added to the table.

In the Data view mode, your columns will now be set to what you have entered as the Field Caption and you can start filling in the data. The Primary Key will automatically be assigned to each new entry in the table.

Just press [Enter] or [F2] to fill text into the cell. If you press [Esc], whatever changes you have made within the cell will not be saved. [Shift]+[Enter] will save all the changes you have made to the row that is currently being edited. By pressing [Del], only the text within the cell will get erased, but if you want to erase the entire row you need to press [Ctrl]+[Del].

Designing queries

Kexi allows you to create database queries and link multiple tables to these queries so that you can filter or limit the incoming data to a set of particular rows and columns. To create a new Query right-click on Queries in the Project Navigator's pane and select Create Object: Query. Now in the Queries window, there will be a drop down menu from which you can select the tables that have been created. Once selected, click the Add button. Multiple tables can be opened in the Queries window this way.

To add relation links between two tables you have to drag and drop the id field from one table and drag and drop it into the id field of another table. This will link both those fields together. To delete a link between two tables you need to first select the line that links the two